



GRAMMAR SESSION 4 • 6TH AUGUST

Reported Speech

Direct & Indirect Speech — Rules, Tense Change, Narration

Class 8 – 10 | SSC & CBSE

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

Quick Revision: Sessions 1–3



Session 1 (3 Aug)

Parts of Speech, Subject-Verb Agreement, Question Tags, Prepositions



Session 2 (4 Aug)

Tenses — Present / Past / Future × Simple / Continuous / Perfect / Perfect Continuous



Session 3 (5 Aug)

Active & Passive Voice — changing the subject and object of a sentence



Tenses matter today too — Reported Speech is basically "what happens to tense when you retell someone's words"!

What We'll Cover



Narration Basics

Direct vs Indirect Speech, Reporter & Reporting Verb



Tense Changes

All 12 tense-shift rules, tense by tense



Modals & Exceptions

can → could, universal truths, historical facts



Master Reference Table

One-page revision anchor for everything



Pronoun Changes

The SON rule — Subject, Object, No change



Time & Place Words

now → then, today → that day, here → there



Sentence Types

Assertive, Interrogative, Imperative, Exclamatory



PYQ Practice

6 exam-style questions to test yourself

What Is Narration?

DS

Narration is the art of reporting the words of a speaker. There are two ways to report what someone said:

1. DIRECT SPEECH

The actual words of the speaker are put inside quotation marks.

Aditya said, "I am very busy now."

2. INDIRECT SPEECH

The speaker's words are transformed and reported in our own, simple sentence.

Aditya said that he was very busy then.

Know the three parts of a reported sentence:

Aditya

Reporter

the person who spoke

said

Reporting Verb

the verb introducing the speech

"I am very busy now."

Reported Speech

the exact words spoken

5 Basic Rules of Indirect Speech

1 No Quotation Marks. Words of the speaker are never enclosed in inverted commas in indirect speech. *Q. M.*

2 Use the Word "that". The conjunction "that" joins the reporting verb and the reported speech.
He said, "I write a letter." → He said that he wrote a letter.

3 Change of Tense. The tense of the reported speech usually shifts backward (see the Tense Change slides ahead).

4 Change of Pronoun. Pronouns change according to the subject/object of the reporting verb.
He said, "I eat two apples." → He said that he ate two apples.

5 Change of Time & Place. Words like today, now, here change to that day, then, there.

Change of Pronouns — the SON Rule

Pronouns change according to three simple letters: S – O – N

S

Subject

1st person (I, we) changes to match the SUBJECT of the reporting verb.

O

Object

2nd person (you) changes to match the OBJECT of the reporting verb.

N

No Change

3rd person (he, she, they) does not change at all.

Common pronoun changes:

Direct	Indirect
I, We	He/She, They
My, Our	His/Her, Their
Me, Us	Him/Her, Them
You, Your	(changes with object of reporting verb)

Example:

She says to me, "I like your book."

→ She says to me that she likes my book.



When your friend says "my chocolate," but by lunch break it becomes "he said it was HIS chocolate" — that's pronoun change in action!

RULE IN FOCUS

Change of Time & Place Words

Because indirect speech is reported later and often from a different place, words showing "nearness" change to words showing "distance".

Direct	Indirect
<u>now</u>	<u>then</u>
here	<u>there</u>
<u>today</u>	<u>that day</u>
<u>tonight</u>	that night
<u>this / these</u>	that / those
<u>thus</u>	<u>so</u>

Direct	Indirect
yesterday	the day before
tomorrow	the next day
last week	the previous week
next week	the following week
ago	before
come	go

Example: She said, "I am buying a laptop today." → **She said that she was buying a laptop that day.**



ORDER

Mom says "come here now" — an hour later when you tell your friend, it becomes "she asked me to go there then"!

Tense Change — the Master List

If the reporting verb is in the PAST tense, the tense of the reported speech shifts back, following these 12 rules:

1. Simple Present → Simple Past

3. Present Perfect → Past Perfect

5. Simple Past → Past Perfect

7. Past Perfect → Past Perfect (no change)

9. will → would

11. will have → would have

2. Present Progressive → Past Progressive

4. Present Perfect Progressive → Past Perfect Progressive

6. Past Progressive → Past Perfect Progressive

8. Past Perfect Progressive → no change

10. will be → would be

12. will have been → would have been

Simple Present & Progressive → Past

SIMPLE PRESENT → SIMPLE PAST

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
She said, "I work in a hospital."	She said that she <u>worked</u> in a hospital.
They said, "We play football."	They said that they <u>played</u> football.
She said, "I don't waste time."	She said that she <u>didn't</u> waste time.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE → PAST PROGRESSIVE

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
He said, "I am waiting for someone."	He said that he <u>was</u> waiting for someone.
She said, "They are enjoying the music."	She said that they <u>were</u> enjoying the music.
David said, "I am not going to college."	David said that he <u>was not</u> going to college.



If reporting verb is present/future, the tense doesn't change at all! "She says, 'I am hungry'" → "She says that she is hungry."

Present Perfect & Perfect Continuous → Past

PRESENT PERFECT → PAST PERFECT

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
She said, "I have completed the work."	She said that she had completed the work.
John said, "I have won a prize."	John said that he had won a prize.
David said, "I have not met her."	David said that he had not met her.

PRESENT PERFECT PROGRESSIVE → PAST PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
She said, "I have been working in a factory for two years."	She said that she had been working in a factory for two years.
They said, "We have been living in America since 2013."	They said that they had been living in America since 2013.



Notice the pattern: whatever "perfect" tense you start with, it just moves one step back into its "past" version.

Simple Past & Progressive → Perfect Forms

past
~~PAST SIMPLE~~ → PAST PERFECT *said to → told*

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
<u>He said, "I started a job."</u>	He said that he had started a job.
<u>She said, "I bought a new car."</u>	She said that she had bought a new car.
<u>He said to me, "You didn't help me."</u>	He said to me that I had not helped him. ✓ <i>told</i>

PAST PROGRESSIVE → PAST PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
<u>He said, "I was writing a poem."</u>	He said that he had been writing a poem.
<u>The kids said, "We were playing a game."</u>	The kids said that they had been playing a game.
She said, "I was not making a noise."	She said that she had not been making a noise.

No Change + Future → "Would" Family

PAST PERFECT → PAST PERFECT (no change in tense)

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
They said, " <u>We</u> had won the game."	They said that they had won the game.
David said, " <u>I</u> had passed the exam."	David said that <u>he</u> had passed the exam.

FUTURE TENSES → "WOULD" FAMILY

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
will → would : She said, " <u>I will go to London.</u> "	She said that she would go to London.
will be → would be : David said, " <u>I will be making tea.</u> "	David said that he <u>would be making tea.</u>
will have → would have : He said, " <u>I will have cleaned the room.</u> "	He said that he would have cleaned the room.



Cricket commentary in reported speech: Dhoni said, "I will win this match for India" → Dhoni said that he would win the match!

EXCEPTIONS

When the Tense Does NOT Change

says Rep. verb - Pre Enters

Universal Truth

Our teacher said, "The earth is round." → Our teacher said that the earth is round.

Habitual Fact

Rajiv said to me, "He plays with his right hand." → Rajiv told me that he plays with his right hand.

Historical Fact

S P → P P

Our teacher said, "Ashoka left war after the conquest of Kalinga." → ...that Ashoka left war after the conquest of Kalinga.

Two Simultaneous Actions

He said, "My wife was making lunch when I was studying." → ...that his wife was making lunch when he was studying.

Imagined Condition (If-clauses)

She said, "If I were rich, I would help him." → She said that if she were rich, she would help him.

Modals: Present → Past

Present modals change to their past forms:

Change	Example
can → could	He said, "I can sing a song." → He said that <u>he could sing a song.</u>
may → might	She said, "I may go to Paris." → She said that <u>she might go to Paris.</u>

MUST

usually stays unchanged:

He said, "I must study this book."
→ He said that he must study that book.

These modals never change: Should, Might, Could, Would, Ought to

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
He said, "I <u>should start a job.</u> "	He said that <u>he should start a job.</u>
David said, "I <u>could buy a camera.</u> "	David said that <u>he could buy a camera.</u>
Gabbar said, "I <u>ought to avoid unhealthy diets.</u> "	Gabbar said that <u>he ought to avoid unhealthy diets.</u>

Assertive (Statement) Sentences

She says to me
They say to Aditya

Rule 1 — Reporting verb: If there is an object after the reporting verb, change say → tell, says → tells, said → told.

Rule 2 — Conjunction: Put "that" in place of the quotation marks, and change pronouns as per the SON rule.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
<u>says</u> She said to me, "I shall sleep now."	She told me that she would sleep then.
He said, "My brother's marriage comes off next month."	He said that his brother's marriage would come off the following month.

Other words that can replace "said to" depending on context:

- replied • informed • stated • added • remarked • asserted • assured • pleaded • reminded • reported • complained



It's like a teacher marking attendance — "said" is the generic word, but "complained," "assured," "reminded" tell us HOW it was said.

Interrogative Sentences — Yes/No Questions

- ✓ Reporting verb said/said to → asked (or enquired / demanded)
- ✓ Comma and inverted commas are removed; "that" is NOT used
- ✓ Question mark (?) is removed — sentence becomes assertive (positive) form
- ✓ For Yes/No questions, use "if" or "whether" in place of the quotes

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
David said to me, " <u>Do you like coffee?</u> "	David asked me <u>whether</u> I liked coffee.
He said to me, " <u>Will you help me?</u> "	He asked me if I would help him.
They told me, " <u>Have you gone to London?</u> "	They asked me if I had gone to London.
John said to her, " <u>Will you buy the book?</u> "	John asked her whether she would buy the book.

When to Use Only "Whether"

With "or not": Use "whether... or not" (do not use "if... or not").

Example: She asked whether or not she should go.

Before an infinitive (to + verb):

Example: I cannot decide whether to go.

After a preposition

Example: They talked about whether the plan would work.

Listing clear choices:

Example: He asked whether we wanted tea or coffee.

Interrogative Sentences — Wh Questions

For questions starting with what, why, how, when, where, who (the "Wh family"): **no conjunction (if/whether/that) is used** — the question word itself joins the sentence.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
He said to me, "What are you doing?"	He asked me what I was doing.
She said to me, "What is your name?"	She asked me what my name was.
David said to me, "How are you?"	David asked me how I was.
They said to me, "Where have you gone?"	They asked me where I had gone.
Teacher told her, "Why did you fail the exam?"	The teacher asked her why she had failed the exam.
The student said, "How can I buy this book?"	The student asked how he could buy this book.



Notice "did you fail" becomes "had failed" — the tense STILL shifts back, even though there's no "that"!

Imperative Sentences — Commands & Requests

An imperative sentence expresses a command, request, advice, or suggestion. To report it, the verb "said/told" is replaced by a specific verb, joined with the conjunction "to".

Command → <u>ordered</u>	Request → <u>requested</u>	Advice → <u>advised</u>	Suggestion → <u>suggested</u>
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Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
She said to me, "Please help me."	She requested me <u>to</u> help her.
Teacher <u>said to him</u> , " <u>Do not waste your time.</u> "	The teacher advised him <u>not to</u> waste his time.
The Boss <u>said to the employee</u> , " <u>Get out of the room.</u> "	The Boss <u>ordered the employee</u> <u>to</u> get out of the room.
He <u>said to his servant</u> , " <u>Clean the room.</u> "	He <u>ordered his servant</u> <u>to</u> clean the room.

 Mom said, "Do your homework NOW!" isn't a request, it's an order — so it becomes "Mom ordered me to do my homework" *then*

Exclamatory Sentences

Exclamatory sentences express strong feeling (joy, sorrow, surprise). "Said" is replaced with a phrase matching the emotion of the exclamatory word, and "What/How" become "very/great".

Exclamatory Word	Replace "said" with
Wow! / Hurrah! / Ha!	exclaimed with joy
What! / Oh!	exclaimed with surprise
Alas! / Ah!	exclaimed with sorrow / grief
Pooh! / Nonsense!	exclaimed with contempt
Well done! / Bravo!	applauded / exclaimed with applause

Direct: Gaurav said "Hurrah! We have won the match."
Indirect: Gaurav exclaimed with joy that they had won the match.

Direct: She said, "Oh! I lost my mobile."
Indirect: She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her mobile.



When India wins a cricket match, "Hurrah! We won!" turns into "The fans exclaimed with joy that they had won" — same excitement, formal tone!

Master Table — Reported Speech at a Glance

PRONOUNS

I / We	He-She / They
My / Our	His-Her / Their
Me / Us	Him-Her / Them
You / Your	I-He-She / My-His-Her

TIME & PLACE

now	then
here	there
today	that day
tomorrow	next day
yesterday	day before
this/these	that/those

MODALS

can	could
may	might
will	would
shall	should
should/could/would/might/ought to	no change

TENSE SHIFT

Present Simple	Past Simple
Present Progressive	Past Progressive
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Present Perfect Progressive	Past Perfect Progressive

Past Simple	Past Perfect
Past Progressive	Past Perfect Progressive
Past Perfect	no change
Future (will)	would

Previous Year Questions (1-3)

Q1

8 SB

Change into Indirect Speech: She said, "I am writing a letter to my friend."

her
that she was

Q2

8 CBSE

Change into Indirect Speech: He said to me, "Will you come to my party tomorrow?"

2/11 *He asked me if I would come to his party the next day.*

Q3

9 CBSE

Change into Indirect Speech: The teacher said, "The sun rises in the east."

that

Previous Year Questions (4-6)

8 SB

Q4

Change into Indirect Speech: She said, "Alas! I have lost my purse."

SM She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her purse.

10 SB

Q5

Change into Indirect Speech: The doctor said to the patient, "Take rest and drink plenty of water."

The doctor advised the patient to ~~take~~ take - - - .

10 CBSE

Q6

Change into Indirect Speech: They said, "We had finished our homework before dinner."

that
They thus

Today's Recap



Narration

Direct Speech (exact words) vs Indirect Speech (reported words)



Time & Place

now→then, today→that day, here→there



Modals

can→could, may→might; should/could/would/might/ought to stay same



Pronouns

Change using the S-O-N rule



Tense Shift

12 rules — tense generally moves one step into the past



4 Sentence Types

Assertive, Interrogative, Imperative, Exclamatory each have their own conjunction rule



Great Work Today!

Practice the worksheet & revise the Master Table before the next session.